

# François Leblanc

Gatineau, Québec, Canada

Phone: 819.208.4089

GitHub: <https://github.com/leblancfg>

Email: [leblancfg@gmail.com](mailto:leblancfg@gmail.com)

Website: <https://leblancfg.com>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/fran%C3%A7ois-leblanc-07294b106/>

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## PROFILE

Senior software engineer at Shopify working on Developer AI systems. Previously worked as a data scientist and data engineer on HR systems, geospatial systems, secure data environments, applied machine learning, and government data products.

## SKILLS

- Main languages are Python, TypeScript, SQL, bash
- Familiar with Ruby, R, Rust, C++, others
- AI developer tools, LLM workflows, agentic systems, RAG, MCP
- Data engineering, analytics, statistics, applied machine learning
- Geospatial analysis, remote sensing, GIS, PostGIS, Leaflet, Esri tools
- Secure data environments, cloud platforms, automation, dashboards
- Product prototyping, technical writing, user-facing tools
- French: native
- English: EEE

## EXPERIENCE

### Shopify

#### Senior Software Engineer, Developer AI

2024—present

- Build AI-assisted tools for engineering teams.
- Work on a PR review bot that uses internal company knowledge, code context, and historical review patterns to support better engineering decisions.
- Built the first Shopify MCP server for an internal RAG knowledge-base access pattern.
- Made accessible all internal MCP servers to our internal chat interface, via a simple-to-use proxy.
- Prototype and evaluate agent workflows, tool use, retrieval patterns, and developer-facing UX for AI systems.

#### Senior Data Engineer, People Analytics

2020—2024

- Worked on HR systems, processes, and internal tools during Shopify's transition to an all-remote company.
- Worked under CEO feedback on internal product areas including:
- Shopify OS [\[article\]](#),
- Mastery [\[article\]](#)
- Flex Comp [\[article\]](#)
- remote-company tooling [\[article\]](#).
- Built data pipelines, analytics, decision-support tools, and internal product features for recruitment, market compensation, talent, and company-operating workflows.
- Collaborated with data, product, engineering, design, and executive stakeholders on tools used by employees across the company.

## **Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat**

### **Data Scientist**

2019—2020

- Built a secure Azure-based data-science environment used by data-science teams across the department.
- Prototyped machine-learning, statistics, and data-engineering applications with teams of analysts.
- Led a 10-week interdepartmental Bayesian inference study group in collaboration with the Canadian School of Public Service's Digital Academy.

## **Environment and Climate Change Canada**

### **Data Scientist, Data Lab**

2018—2019

- Worked on a multidisciplinary team building data solutions for department-wide problems.
- Used statistics, machine learning, data engineering, and visualization to rapidly prototype tools for policy and program teams.
- Used deep learning to automate bird counting and positioning from aerial imagery with Python, Keras, and Azure.
- Applied text analytics to public consultations with Python, gensim, and spaCy, helping analysts understand thousands of comments more efficiently.
- Automated departmental shuttle rider sign-in with onboard tablets, employee card readers, Power BI, PHP, and Azure.

### **Physical Science Officer, National Pollutant Release Inventory**

2017—2018

- Worked on pollution-release data for Canadian public reporting, researchers, NGOs, and internal users.
- Managed geospatial workflows including Open Data map-layer publication, spatial statistics, and quality assurance of self-reported data.
- Used Python, PostGIS, Leaflet.js, Esri ArcMap, and ArcGIS Online.
- Led public-facing pollution-science communication projects, including interactive sector overviews, NPRI infographics, and a science-festival exhibit.

## **Canadian Space Agency**

### **Mission Planner, Data Acquisition**

2017

- Planned RADARSAT-2 Synthetic Aperture Radar imagery acquisitions for Government of Canada clients, university research teams, national-security use cases, humanitarian-aid operations, and the International Charter Space and Major Disasters.
- Oversaw and co-wrote a tested and documented Python package to automate RADARSAT-2 image-acquisition planning tasks.
- Worked with satellite-imagery users across research and operational contexts.

### **Data and Visualization Analyst, Human Resources Branch**

2015—2017

- Built data pipelines to extract, transform, and load HR data from multiple databases into explorable datasets.
- Led development and maintenance of bilingual Tableau dashboards for HR advisors, managers, and executives.
- Supported workforce planning and analysis with automated reporting and interactive visualization.

## **Transport Canada**

### **Production Support Specialist**

2015

- Automated government ID card production with Python, OpenCV, and Bash.
- Audited and analyzed workflow for the Inspector Equipment warehouse.
- Helped streamline financial coding for postal services with Excel and VBA.

## Où Quoi? Salon Urbain

### Bartender, Menu Director

2012—2015

- Managed bar service, menu development, customer experience, and day-to-day operational work in a small hospitality business.
- Prototyped new recipes and ingredients: liqueurs, soda concentrates, clarification, distillation.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

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### pi-fusion (2026)

Local inference-time scaling and compound model panels for coding agents. Extension for the [pi](#) coding agent.

- Project: <https://github.com/leblancfg/pi-fusion>
- Write-up: <https://leblancfg.com/pi-fusion-local-inference-time-scaling-for-coding-agents>

### Intensity Systems / Sledgehammer Pad (2026)

A hardware/product prototype, a "power-meter-enabled" pad for sledgehammer workouts, built during a focused startup sprint. Still WIP.

- Site: <https://intensity.systems>
- Write-up: <https://leblancfg.com/intensity-pad>

### deprecations.info (2025)

A public tracker for AI model deprecations across providers.

- Site: <https://deprecations.info>
- Source: <https://github.com/deprecations/deprecations-rss>

### autocrop (2015)

A Python face-aware image-cropping tool.

- Docs: <https://leblancfg.com/autocrop>
- Source: <https://github.com/leblancfg/autocrop>

## EDUCATION

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### UC Irvine Extension

#### Data Science Certificate

2015—2019

### University of Ottawa

#### Bachelor of Science, Geology and Physics

2007—2012